

BFS218

# Racism and the Digital Age

## Understanding Techno-Racism

A short, friendly map to your course companion site, what it is, where everything lives, and how to make it work for you.

ONLINE SYNCHRONOUS

### The Field Guide

The address is in your Blackboard course menu. Your saved work lives in your own browser on your own device.

## START HERE

### Your reading room, not another inbox

The companion site gathers every assigned reading, key concept, walkthrough, and self-check for BFS218 into one calm place, organized the way the course actually runs. No account, no login, nothing you do here is graded or tracked. Read, practise, and explore freely.



#### What it is

- Your course reading room, in working order
- Every reading, concept, and self-check in one spot
- A companion that sits beside Blackboard



#### What it is not

- Not a replacement for Blackboard
- Not where announcements or submissions live
- Not graded, tracked, or reported, ever

# The menu is the map

The left-hand menu is the entire site. Here is every door and where it leads.

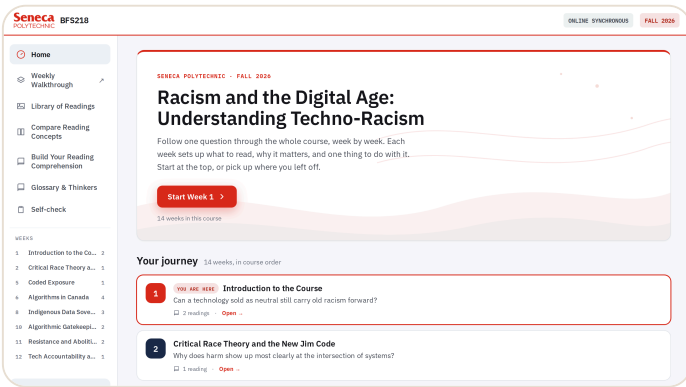
|                                                                                                                                                                |                                                                                                                                                                       |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| ● ● ● BFS218 Field Guide, navigation                                                                                                                           |                                                                                                                                                                       |
|  <b>Home</b><br>The course journey, week by week                              |  <b>Library of Readings</b><br>Every assigned source, as a card                      |
|  <b>Compare Reading Concepts</b><br>Hold up to three readings side by side    |  <b>Build Your Reading Comprehension</b><br>Turn any reading into practice questions |
|  <b>Glossary &amp; Thinkers</b><br>Every key term, and the scholars behind it |  <b>Self-check</b><br>Flip cards & short quizzes, never scored                       |
|  <b>Weekly Walkthrough</b><br>Every week's narrated deck, in one hub          |  <b>By week · Tiles · Index</b><br>Three more ways into the same library             |

HOME

# The course as a journey

Home lays the course out week by week. Each station shows the week's title and its **guiding question**, the one question worth carrying through everything you read that week.

- 1
- Click any week station to open that week's page.
- 2
- Coming back later? The site remembers where you were on this device and offers to pick up where you left off.



HOME · THE COURSE JOURNEY, EACH WEEK WITH ITS GUIDING QUESTION

# Anatomy of a week

Every week page runs in the order the week is meant to run. Work it top to bottom.

**This week in 80 seconds.** Content weeks open with a short animated overview under the week title, made with NotebookLM from that week's readings and reviewed by your instructor. Captions available on the player. It is a fast on-ramp into the week, not a substitute for the readings.

**Study Guide.** Before the Knowledge Check, each teaching week carries a rehearsal space: a quick warm-up from earlier weeks, explain-it-back cards where you put each key concept in your own words and compare with the reading, and a question ladder that works the week's guiding questions from recall to application. Nothing is recorded or graded; your notes stay in your own browser.

**Knowledge Check.** Every week closes with an optional, never scored set of quick questions: this week's ideas plus a short review from earlier weeks, so the knowledge keeps building. Every answer explains itself from the readings, you can clear or change any answer, and when you finish a set, a short summary tells you where you stand and what to revisit. Three sets let you test yourself again fresh.

- 1 **Time budget**, under the title, roughly how the week's work divides up.
- 2 **Overview & How this week works**, read this first; it tells you what to do and in what order.
- 3 **Purpose & Outcomes**, what you should be able to do by the end. Test yourself against these sentences.
- 4 **Guiding Questions**, carry at least one with you into the readings.
- 5 **Key Concepts**, each explained and cited to that week's reading, so you always know where an idea comes from.
- 6 **Readings**, full citation and a button. Open access, Seneca Library, Read on Blackboard, or Revisit from an earlier week.
- 7 **The Walkthrough**, a slide deck embedded on the page. Arrow keys move through it, or open it fullscreen.
- 8 **The Activity**, press Start and follow the prompts. Practice, not assessment.
- 9 **Reflect**, a short prompt (one or two sentences) to close the week.
- 10 **You can now**, the week's closing checklist. Tick what you can genuinely do; anything left unticked shows exactly what to revisit. Reset any time.

**Seneca** BFS218  
POLYTECHNIC

ONLINE SYNCHRONOUS FALL 2026

[Home](#)  
[Weekly Walkthrough](#)  
[Library of Readings](#)  
[Compare Reading Concepts](#)  
[Build Your Reading Comprehension](#)  
[Glossary & Thinkers](#)

[Back to your journey](#)

**WEEK 3**  

## Engineered Inequity

This week opens Part II of the course, where we take the New Jim Code apart one dimension at a time. We begin with the first dimension, engineered inequity: technology that, by its design, amplifies social hierarchies of race, class, and gender while presenting itself as neutral or efficient. The key idea is amplify, not create: the inequality is already in society, and the design widens it, speeds it up, and makes it harder to escape. By the end of the week you should be able to define engineered inequity, answer Benjamin's question are robots racist, and name a real example.

**IN THIS WEEK**

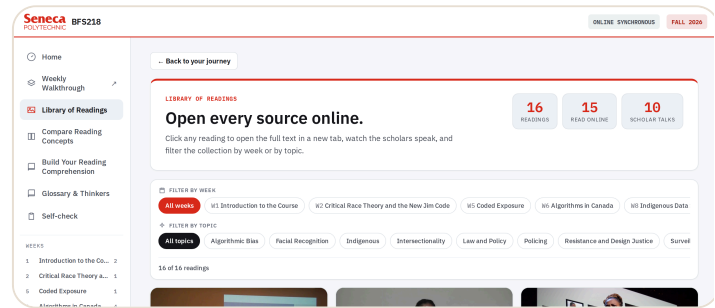
- ☐ Overview
- ☐ This week in 80 seconds
- ☐ Before you begin
- ☐ Purpose
- ☐ Learning outcomes
- ☐ Guiding questions
- ☐ Key concepts
- ☐ You can now

A WEEK PAGE · EVERYTHING IN WORKING ORDER, TOP TO BOTTOM

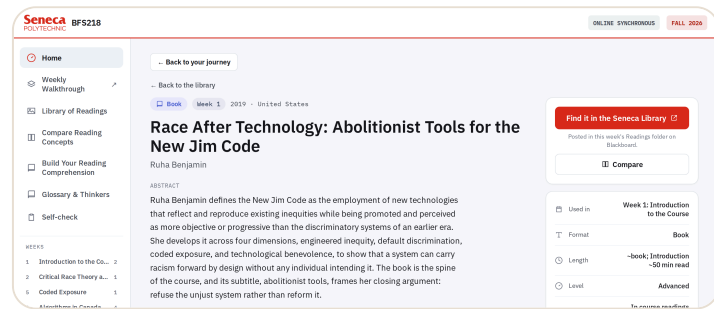
# Every reading, as a card

The library holds every course reading: what it is, what it argues, how long it takes, and how to reach it.

- 1 Search any author, title, or idea.
- 2 Filter to one week with the week strip, or browse by format.
- 3 Click a card for the reading's page: core idea, plain-language abstract, level and length, and where the text lives.
- 4 Press the red button to open the reading. A Source page button appears where a separate source or DOI exists.
- 5 Bookmark a reading to your Saved shelf. It stays on this device so you can return before an assessment.



EVERY SOURCE AS A CARD, SEARCHABLE BY WEEK

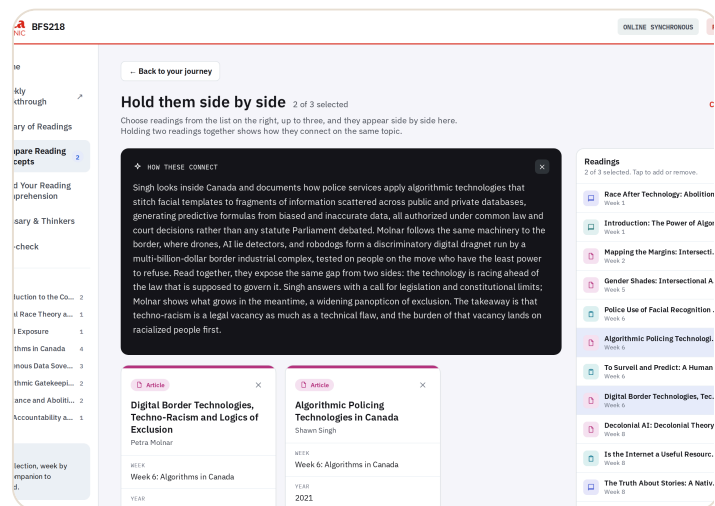


A READING PAGE · CORE IDEA, ABSTRACT, AND THE OPEN BUTTON

## COMPARE READING CONCEPTS

# Hold up to three readings side by side

- 1 Open Compare from the menu, or press Compare on any reading page.
- 2 Pick up to three readings. Each becomes a column: week, year, origin, length, level, and core idea.
- 3 With two or more selected, press **Synthesize their relationship**. The site explains how they speak to each other, every idea attributed.
- 4 With three, it takes the pairings one at a time, then asks what only appears when all three are on the table.
- 5 Remove a reading with the × on its column, or Clear all to start over.



EACH PAIRING EXPLAINED, EVERY IDEA ATTRIBUTED

# Turn any reading into practice

Choose a reading, choose a lens, and answer. Every answer comes back with a short explanation grounded in the reading itself, so a wrong answer still teaches you something specific.

## LENS 01

### Thematic

What it is about.

## LENS 02

### Argument

What it claims, and why.

## LENS 03

### Context

Where it sits in the field and the course.

## GLOSSARY & THINKERS

### Never defined out of thin air

- Browse by week (including the closing weeks) or search any term.
- Every definition carries a citation to that week's assigned reading.
- The *Scholars this week* strip introduces the people behind the readings. Click a name to jump to their reading.

## SELF-CHECK

### Practice, never scored

- Pick a week, or take all weeks together.
- Flip the cards: term on the front, definition and citation on the back.
- Run the short quizzes; each question explains its answer. Nothing is recorded, it exists so you know what to reread before it matters.



**Weekly Walkthrough hub.** Every week's deck also lives in one place. Open it from the menu and pick the week to rewatch without hunting.

## HANDS-ON

### The studios & labs

Alongside the weekly activities, the site carries hands-on labs. Each one tells you what you are doing and why before you start. Nothing in them is graded.

#### Evidence Transfer Lab

Move a claim from source to argument, deliberately.

#### Accountability Chain Lab

Trace who answers for a harm, link by link.

#### Self-Check Studio

Package your studio work as a Word document to keep.

### THREE MORE WAYS INTO THE LIBRARY

## Browse it however you think

### By week

Everything, week by week.

### Tiles

The whole library as a wall you can scan.

### Index

The alphabetical list.

### GOOD HABITS FOR THE TERM

## A rhythm that works

#### STEP 1

Open the week page early and read the overview.

#### STEP 2

Do the readings with one guiding question in hand.

#### STEP 3

Step through the walkthrough.

#### STEP 4

Do the activity.

#### STEP 5

Tick the You can now checklist honestly.

Before each assessment, use **Compare** on the readings you plan to write about, and run **Self-check** for those weeks.

### PRACTICAL NOTES

## Good to know

- Works on phones, tablets, and laptops, and is fully keyboard-navigable.
- Your saved shelf, checklists, and progress live only in your own browser, on your own device.
- Clearing browser data clears them, and they do not follow you between devices.
- If the site looks stale after an announced update, refresh the page once.

### THE ONE RULE THAT MATTERS

## When in doubt, Blackboard wins.

The companion site is your reading room. Blackboard is the course of record: announcements, discussions, every submission, and every grade live there, and the course outline is the authoritative schedule.

## Where to go for what

|                                       |                                                |
|---------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Start this week's work</b>         | Home ► click the week ► work top to bottom     |
| <b>Find a reading fast</b>            | Library of Readings ► search or week strip     |
| <b>See how readings connect</b>       | Compare Reading Concepts ► pick up to three    |
| <b>Test yourself on a reading</b>     | Build Your Reading Comprehension ► pick a lens |
| <b>Look up a term</b>                 | Glossary & Thinkers ► search                   |
| <b>Drill before an assessment</b>     | Self-check ► pick the weeks                    |
| <b>Rewatch the week's deck</b>        | Weekly Walkthrough ► pick the week             |
| <b>Submit anything / check grades</b> | Blackboard, always                             |